

The US, USSR, and UK sign the **Partial, or Limited, Test Ban Treaty**, a first step toward nuclear disarmament.



1963

In the case of **Miranda v. Arizona**, the US Supreme Court rules that suspects in police custody must be told of their right to remain silent.



1966

California introduces the principle of the **no-fault divorce**.



1969

In the **Roe v. Wade** case, the Supreme Court rules in favor of a woman's legal right to abortion in the US.



1973

1964



The **Civil Rights Act** outlaws discrimination on grounds of race in the US.

1966



The **International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR)** is drafted to complement the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

1970



The **Federal Witness Protection Program** is introduced to combat organized crime in the US.

1973



The US government introduces the **Endangered Species Act**.

not least to rebuild industries and foster economic regeneration. Lessons had been learned from the consequences of the punitive settlement imposed on Germany after World War I. In place of retribution, reconciliation—in particular, between France and Germany—led to the creation of new European institutions.

The 12 member nations of the Council of Europe agreed to a Convention on Human Rights in 1950, and the European Coal and Steel Community, which later grew into the European Union (EU), established the European Court of Justice in 1952. A similar spirit of cooperation led to the creation of the Nordic Council in 1952. A decade later, this body adopted the Helsinki Treaty, which paved the way for closer integration

of the Scandinavian countries. In stark contrast, tensions grew on either side of the “Iron Curtain,” with the “communist” bloc of the USSR, its allies, and China on one side and the US and the capitalist West on the other. Each camp increased its nuclear arsenal, with things coming to a head during the Cuban Missile Crisis of 1962. In its wake came international talks to restrict the proliferation of nuclear weapons, resulting in the Partial, or Limited, Test Ban Treaty in 1963.

Social change

As well as international efforts to promote and protect human rights, there were growing movements, especially in the US, pressing for social change with legal reinforcement. The civil rights movement grew out of African

American anger against the discriminatory “Jim Crow” laws, leading eventually to the Civil Rights Act of 1964. Women’s rights were also forcibly put on the agenda by the rise of feminism, and changes were brought about in the laws on such issues as abortion and divorce.

There was also a growing concern for environmental issues, as the effects of human interference with nature became more apparent. In 1973, both the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES) and the US Endangered Species Act were enacted. They began to address the need to protect the natural world, but they did not yet deal with the deeper ecological implications of the loss of biodiversity. ■